The Believer’s Education

Paul labors for believers he has never seen so that, knit together in love, they will come to the full knowledge of God’s mystery — Christ Himself, the treasury of all wisdom — and keep walking in Him as they received Him.

Where this study fits

Colossians · twelve studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–8 **Faith, Love, and Hope in Colossae**	**02 1:9–14** **Paul's Prayer for the Colossians**	**03 1:15–23** **The Savior of the Gospel**	**04 1:24–29** **Christ in You, the Hope of Glory**
05 2:1–7 **The Believer's Education**	**06 2:8–15** **Beware of Philosophy**	**07 2:16–23** **Run the Race Set Before You**	**08 3:1–11** **Looking Up, Putting Off**
09 3:12–17 **Service Manual for the Lord's Army**	**10 3:18–4:1** **The Relationships of the New Man**	**11 4:2–6** **Perfecting the Prayer Life**	**12 4:7–18** **Portrait of a Ministry Team**

Paul’s education for believers

Colossians 2:1–7 · The commentary’s outline

I. His wish	II. His warning	III. His assurance	IV. His admonition
ἀγών A struggle for unseen believers: hearts encouraged, knit in love, knowing Christ	**πιθανολογία** Let no one delude you with persuasive argument	**τάξις · στερέωμα** Absent in body, present in spirit — rejoicing in their order and firm faith	**περιπατεῖτε** As you received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk in Him
vv.1–3	v.4	v.5	vv.6–7

The defense is already in place before the error is named: Christ is enough.

Three steps to strengthened hearts

Colossians 2:2–3 · Outline I.C — The reason for the wish

Prerequisite	Sub-purpose	Final purpose	In Him
συμβιβάζω Hearts knit together in love — joined like the body's joints	**πληροφορία** All the wealth of the full assurance of understanding — settled conviction	A true knowledge of God's mystery — Christ Himself	**θησαυρός · ἀπόκρυφος** "All the treasures of wisdom and knowledge" are hidden
v.2a · Aor. Pass. Ptc.	v.2b	v.2c	v.3

The real hidden treasures are not stored in a secret society. They are stored in Christ — open to every believer.

Not deluded — standing firm

Colossians 2:4–5 · Outline II–III — Paul's warning and assurance

The warning — v.4
παραλογίζομαι · πιθανολογία

"Delude" — to cheat by false reasoning

"Persuasive argument" — plausible, smooth talk (only here in the NT)

Today: "all religions are equally true paths to God"

Answer: John 14:6; Eph 2:8–9

vs

The assurance — v.5
τάξις · στερέωμα · military words

Good discipline — an army in unbroken ranks

Stability — a solid front, a line that does not give way

Not Corinth in disorder, not Galatia "so quickly deserting" (Gal 1:6)

Seen through the eyes of Epaphras

They had been taught that salvation is a gift with no works necessary — so "you need one more thing" found no foothold.

Walk the way you started

Colossians 2:6–7 · Outline IV — The measure and manner of the walk

v.6	“As you have received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk in Him” — the full Christ, not a reduced one	**παραλαμβάνω** received, as teaching handed down
v.7a	Firmly rooted in Him — roots set in Christ when we believed, and they stay there	**ῥιζόω** Perf. Pass. — rooted, remaining so
v.7b	Now being built up in Him — story by story; the Master Builder does the work	**ἐποικοδομέω** Pres. Pass. — continuous
v.7c	Established in your faith — confirmed in the truth “just as you were instructed”	**βεβαιόω** Pres. Pass. — made firm
v.7d	Overflowing with gratitude — for everything, even the hard things	**περισσεύω** Pres. ACTIVE — our part

Three passives, one active: growth is God’s doing; thankfulness is ours.

Discuss and apply

Colossians 2:1–7 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What was the false teachers' basic claim about Jesus, and why is it so dangerous?

2. What does it mean to walk in Christ "as you have received" Him (v.6)?

Apply

Look Deeper into Christ, Not Beyond Him
Read Colossians 1:15–2:3 slowly this week and list every treasure you find in Christ.

Walk the Way You Started
Each morning pray: "Lord, as I received You by grace, help me walk in You by grace today."

In one line: Every treasure is already in Christ — so keep walking in Him the way you began: by grace, through faith.